a pair of football helmets and weren't much fun to wear. Each lens had a little bubble over your cornea that you had to keep filled with a saline solution, and every couple of hours, the solution would turn gray and you'd find yourself blinded until you replaced the fluid. They were difficult to wear but vanity prevailed, although I found out I couldn't use them much in pictures because they had the effect of making me look a little pop-eyed on the screen. So unless I was doing a long shot or a stunt in which I felt I needed good vision more than a good appearance, I didn't use them during filming.

I was proud of some of the B pictures we made, but a lot of them were pretty poor. They were movies the studio didn't want good, they wanted 'em Thursday.

Until I got the part of George Gipp in *Knute Rockne—All American*, I was the Errol Flynn of the B pictures. I usually played a jet-propelled newspaperman who solved more crimes than a polygraph machine. My one unvarying line, which I always snapped into a telephone, was: "Give me the city desk. I've got a story that will crack this town wide open!"

When the studio played you in an A picture, you always hoped it would generate the kind of reviews and fan mail and audience response at previews that would get you promoted out of the B Unit. But there were a lot of disappointments. You'd make an A picture and think you did okay and then find yourself back in the B's, a little frustrated and saying unkind things about the studio's judgment.

When I arrived in Hollywood, actors and actresses had just won a tough five-year battle with studios for the union shop and recognition of the Screen Actors Guild as the exclusive bargaining agent for actors. Like all contract players, I'd had to join the union and wasn't very happy about it. Making me